

SEN Teaching Assistant – Primary

SEN Teaching Assistants at Leigh Academies Trust are pivotal in providing specialised support and practical assistance to pupils with Special Educational Needs (SEN), ensuring their personal welfare and facilitating their access to a high-quality education. They play an indispensable role in developing and implementing effective SEN strategies and practices within the academy, cultivating a safe, inclusive, and nurturing learning environment where every child can thrive. SEN Teaching Assistants work collaboratively with teachers, the SENCO, therapists, and other staff to champion achievement, support individualised learning objectives, and diligently monitor pupil progress, fostering a truly equitable educational experience.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the SEN Teaching Assistant is to deliver targeted support and specialist assistance to pupils with a diverse range of Special Educational Needs, both within the vibrant classroom setting and in dedicated Inclusion spaces. They expertly utilise a wide array of strategies and methods to support pupils' learning, which may encompass providing personal care and supporting complex medical needs with sensitivity and professionalism. SEN Teaching Assistants are key contributors to the development and implementation of Individual Education Programmes (IEPs), adeptly adapt learning materials, meticulously monitor pupil progress, and provide insightful, detailed feedback to teachers.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Supporting Pupils' Learning and Development

- To work closely with individual pupils and small groups of pupils with a variety of Special Educational Needs, both within the classroom and in the Inclusion base, enabling them to confidently access the curriculum and achieve their personal best.
- To apply a wide range of specialist strategies and methods to support pupils' diverse learning needs, including, where applicable, providing sensitive personal care and supporting medical needs in accordance with established protocols.
- To actively contribute to the Individual Education Programme (IEP) and Annual Review process for supported pupils, applying specific strategies as meticulously outlined in reviews and assessments to ensure tailored support.
- To prepare and adapt learning materials used in class, ensuring they are fully accessible to pupils with Special Educational Needs, utilising appropriate assistive technologies and resources to foster independence.

2. Collaboration and Communication

- To liaise and work collaboratively with teachers, the SENCO, therapists, and other school staff in the preparation, differentiation, and adaptation of plans and materials, ensuring a cohesive and integrated approach to pupil support.
- To monitor identified pupils diligently in lessons and provide detailed, accurate, and constructive feedback to teachers on participation, progress towards IEP targets, and any identified barriers to learning.
- To complete half-termly reports on pupils' progress towards IEP targets and update pupil passports and other relevant documentation throughout the year, ensuring comprehensive and up-to-date records.
- To work as a valued member of designated teams, including class teams, support teams, and multi-agency teams, contributing positively to effective working relations within the academy and beyond.

3. Promoting Inclusion and Access

- To have due regard for Health & Safety at Work legislation in carrying out all aspects of the post, including conducting risk assessments and manual handling procedures, particularly in relation to pupils with physical disabilities, ensuring a safe environment for all.
- To vigorously promote the Academy's Equal Opportunities and Inclusion policy in all areas of the post, ensuring that pupils with SEN are fully and meaningfully included in all aspects of school life and activities.
- To form and maintain appropriate professional relationships and personal boundaries with children and young people, safeguarding and promoting their welfare, with a particular focus on the unique vulnerabilities of pupils with SEN.

4. Professional Development and Values

- To take proactive responsibility for personal professional development, continuously seeking opportunities to enhance skills and knowledge in the field of SEN.
- To participate actively in the academy's professional development programme as appropriate, including specialised SEN-specific training, to remain at the forefront of best practice.
- To engage actively in the Performance Management Review process, using it as an opportunity for growth and reflection.
- To evaluate personal performance through self-evaluation and learn from the effective practice of others and from evidence, fostering a culture of continuous improvement.
- To support the academy's commitment to providing and monitoring opportunities for the personal and academic growth of pupils, with a specific focus on ensuring that pupils with SEN make significant progress and achieve their individual goals.
- To serve as an exemplary role model through personal and professional conduct, demonstrating an unwavering commitment to inclusion and respect for diversity.
- To be proficient in the application of literacy, numeracy, and ICT, effectively utilising these skills to support pupils with SEN in accessing the curriculum and enhancing their learning experiences.
- To contribute to the effective running of the academy, including actively supporting SEN policy development and implementation, shaping the future of inclusive education.

Person Specification – SEN Teaching Assistant

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the SEN Teaching Assistant role in a primary academy:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Educated to GCSE level standard or equivalent (English and Maths A*–C grade or equivalent).

Desirable:

- Additional qualifications relevant to education or childcare, demonstrating a broader understanding of child development and pedagogy.
- Specialised training in SEN, such as qualifications or certifications related to specific areas like Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD), speech and language difficulties, sensory impairments, or specific learning difficulties (e.g., dyslexia, dyspraxia), showcasing a deep commitment to the field.
- A First Aid qualification, enabling immediate and effective response to medical emergencies.

Experience

Essential:

- Experience of working with children or young people, preferably with experience supporting those with additional needs in an educational setting.

Desirable:

- Proven experience in a similar role or school setting supporting students with SEN, providing a track record of effectively supporting teaching and learning within an educational context.
- Demonstrable experience in implementing specific interventions or support programmes for pupils with SEN, showcasing the ability to deliver targeted support and track progress effectively.
- Experience of collaborating with multi-agency teams, such as therapists, educational psychologists, and social workers, to provide holistic support.
- Experience providing personal care and supporting medical needs, with appropriate training and guidance.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Experience of working with children or young people, preferably with experience supporting those with additional needs in an educational setting.

- Knowledge of a range of effective SEN support strategies and interventions, demonstrating an understanding of different approaches to meet individual needs and promote inclusive practice.
- Understanding of the importance of safeguarding and child protection, with a clear grasp of procedures.
- Knowledge of basic behaviour management strategies tailored for primary school environments.

Desirable:

- Knowledge of specific therapeutic interventions or approaches, such as speech and language therapy techniques or sensory integration strategies, enhancing the ability to provide specialised support.
- Understanding of assistive technologies and their use in supporting pupils with SEN, demonstrating an ability to utilise tools and resources to enhance access to learning.
- Familiarity with the National Curriculum for primary education and how it can be adapted for pupils with SEN.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Strong teamwork and collaboration skills, with the ability to work effectively with teachers, SENCO, and other colleagues to support pupil learning and contribute to a positive team environment.
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills, enabling the post-holder to build positive relationships with pupils, colleagues, and parents, and to communicate clearly and sensitively.
- Effective written and oral communication skills, ensuring accurate record-keeping, clear communication with staff, and the ability to provide constructive feedback to pupils.
- Effective listening skills, demonstrating the ability to understand and respond to the needs of pupils and colleagues with empathy, patience, and understanding.
- Ability to adapt communication to suit different audiences, tailoring language and communication style to the age, needs, and abilities of individual pupils, including those with communication difficulties.
- Ability to follow instructions and implement plans, adhering to guidance from teachers and other professionals to ensure consistency and effectiveness in supporting learning activities.
- Strong organisational skills, enabling the post-holder to manage their time effectively, prioritise tasks, maintain accurate records, and contribute to the efficient running of the classroom.
- Ability to use initiative and problem-solve, proactively identifying and addressing needs within the classroom and taking responsibility for **assigned tasks**.

Desirable:

- Proficient ICT skills, allowing for the effective use of technology to support learning, create resources, and manage data, enhancing engagement and accessibility for pupils.
- Ability to reflect on practice and contribute constructively to the development of SEN provision within the academy, demonstrating a commitment to continuous professional development and improvement.

Personal Qualities

The successful SEN Teaching Assistant will be a **highly motivated** and **enthusiastic** individual with a genuine passion for supporting the development and progress of all pupils, particularly those with additional needs. They will demonstrate an unwavering commitment to creating a **positive and inclusive** learning environment where every child feels **valued, understood, and supported**. Possessing a **collaborative spirit** and **exceptional interpersonal skills**, they will build **strong, respectful relationships** with pupils, colleagues, and parents, fostering **effective communication and teamwork**. The SEN Teaching Assistant will be **reflective and adaptable**, demonstrating a **willingness to learn from experience, embrace new challenges**, and adjust their approach to meet the diverse and evolving needs of pupils. They will be **patient, resilient**, and **possess a calm and positive demeanor**, enabling them to effectively **manage challenging situations** and **provide consistent, empathetic support**. Furthermore, they will uphold the highest standards of professionalism, demonstrating **integrity, empathy**, and an **absolute dedication** to safeguarding the wellbeing of every child.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) [\(Department of Education\)](#).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.

